In Memoriam



Robert Solomon Wistrich

1945–2015

It is with great sadness that we must record here the passing of Professor Robert Wistrich on May 19, 2015 in Rome, where he had been invited to address the Italian Parliament.

Robert Wistrich had a distinguished career, bringing out important studies on Austrian Jewry, the Holocaust, and on the history and current reality of antisemitism. He held the Neuberger Chair for Modern European History at the Hebrew University of Jerusalem; and was head of the Vidal Sassoon Internatioal Center for the Study of Antisemitism from 2002 to 2015.

Born in Kazakhstan in 1945, Prof. Wistrich's family returned to Poland after World War II, later moving to France, and then settling in England, where he grew up. At age 17, he won an Open Scholarship to Cambridge University, where he received his BA and MA degrees. His Ph.D. was awarded by the University of London in 1974.

Along with his academic career, Prof. Wistrich was an advisor for a number of documentaries and films, including the Thames Television 3-part series, *The Longest Hatred* (1993, directed by Rex Bloomstein), which provided a historical overview of anti-Jewish persecution; the BBC's *Blaming the Jews* (2003) about present-day Muslim antisemitism; and for *Obsession: Radical Islam's War against the West* (2006). He served from 1999 until 2001 as one of six scholars appointed to a special international Catholic-Jewish historical commission to review the wartime record of Pope Pius XII. He also served as a rapporteur on antisemitism and related issues for the U.S. Department of State, the Organisation for Security and Cooperation in Europe (OSCE), the Council of Europe (Strasbourg), and the United Nations Commission on Antisemitism and Human Rights and the Human Rights Commission in Geneva.

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